

Step 2 — Understand the repo

Each task is a GitHub repo frozen at the commit immediately before the original PR was merged. Your job is to re-implement that fix, ideally better than the original.

Learn the codebase

Clone the repo and spend time understanding it:

- Run it locally¹ — Get the app or CLI running so you know how it's used.
- Run existing tests² — Confirm the test suite passes and you know the commands.
- Read the code³ — Understand overall organization, key modules, and where the fix will land.

1. Hands-on context beats reading alone
2. You'll need the exact test command for your RunScript
3. Focus on the area the PR touches

Don't rush this. The time you invest here saves time in every subsequent step.

Review the existing solution

The repo has a branch called `existing-solution` with a PR into main. Use it as a reference only:

- Problem¹ — What is the PR solving? What's the current vs expected behavior?
- Approach² — How does the original solution work? What would you keep or improve?
- Tests³ — What tests did they add? You'll adapt these into your F2P set.

1. This informs your `problem_statement` later
2. Your golden solution should be at least as good
3. Start collecting F2P candidates early

Do **not** edit `existing-solution` or copy it wholesale; you're producing your own implementation.

Poor fit or overwhelming?

If after reviewing the repo you feel the task is a poor fit or genuinely overwhelming, flag it with the task ID to the project team on Slack and abandon it. It's better to skip early than to struggle through a mismatched task.

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